



A GEO brief for your agency

Use this to brief a web or content agency on generative engine optimisation: what it is, what good looks like, and exactly what you expect them to deliver. Adapt the bracketed fields, then send it as your brief.

PREPARED FOR [DESTINATION] · WITH THE DIGITAL TOURISM THINK TANK

This is a brief, not a wish. It tells your agency what generative engine optimisation means in practice, the standard we expect, and the deliverables we will judge the work against. It assumes a competent agency and gives them a clear target.

01 What we are asking for

We want [organisation]'s content and wider presence structured so that AI assistants, ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity and Google's AI Overviews, can understand, trust and recommend us. That practice is generative engine optimisation, GEO. It builds on SEO, but the goal shifts from ranking a link to being the source an assistant quotes in its answer. We are asking you to bring our priority pages and our wider presence up to the standard set out below.

02 What good looks like

Six things determine whether an assistant recommends us. Treat each as a standard to meet, not a box to tick.

01

Answer-first content

Priority pages answer the visitor's question in the opening lines, with question-led headings and self contained sections.

02

Structured data that matches

Valid schema on key pages, matched exactly to the visible content, validated, never describing what is not shown.

03

A consistent entity

Name, address and core facts identical across our site, Google Business Profile, the major platforms and, where relevant, Wikidata.

Authority and technical access

Accurate third party listings and reviews, and AI crawler access confirmed in robots.txt, with a fast, mobile-ready site.

03 Scope of work

We expect the engagement to cover the following. Where something is out of scope for this phase, say so explicitly in your proposal.

-  A content audit of our priority pages against the GEO principles, with a prioritised rewrite list.
-  Answer-first rewrites of the agreed priority pages, keeping our brand voice.
-  Schema implementation on key page types, matched to visible content and validated.
-  An entity and consistency pass: name, address and facts aligned across our site and key profiles.
-  A technical check: AI crawler access, mobile performance and page speed.
-  A measurement setup: a priority question set and a simple way to track how we appear over time.

04 What to deliver, and how we will judge it

Deliverable	How we will judge it
Content audit	Priority pages scored against the five principles, with a ranked rewrite list.
Rewrites	Pages answer the question in the opening lines, with specifics, in our voice.
Schema	Valid, matched to visible content, and passing Google's Rich Results Test.
Entity pass	Facts identical across our site and named profiles, with a short consistency report.
Measurement	A documented question set and a tracker we can run ourselves after handover.

05 What we will not accept

-  Hidden text, cloaking or any content written to deceive an assistant.
-  Fabricated or incentivised reviews.
-  Schema that describes anything not visible on the page.
-  FAQ schema presented as a visibility trick rather than genuine answers.
-  Work we cannot maintain ourselves, with no handover or documentation.

DTTT POSITION

Good GEO is not manipulation. It is making genuinely useful, well structured, consistent information easy for a machine to use. Any agency that pitches a trick to game the systems has misunderstood the work, and the risk sits with us, not them.

06 Questions to ask before you appoint

Ask these in the pitch. The answers separate an agency that understands GEO from one repeating the words.

- How do you decide which pages to rewrite first, and how do you measure the result.
- How do you ensure schema matches visible content, and how do you validate it.
- How do you handle our entity and facts across third party platforms.
- What do you hand over so we can maintain this ourselves.
- Where do you draw the line on tactics you will not use, and why.

Prepared with the Digital Tourism Think Tank as part of the [destination] AI Discoverability programme. Adapt the bracketed fields before sending.